a FlexLifeFi K-12 program

Cash & Company

MASTER · STANDARDS & ALIGNMENT

Standards Alignment Map

Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, CASEL, NGSS-ETS - mapped grade by grade.

The single source of truth that lets a district adoption committee, foundation pitch, or grant reviewer confirm Cash to Company aligns with every framework that matters.

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> Standards-rigorous. District-defensible. Foundation-fundable.

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Purpose. Show, by grade, which specific benchmarks each year's program centers. We use the framework name + the actual benchmark — no alignment salad. Where Cash to Company teaches something a framework doesn't name (entrepreneurship-as-discipline at younger grades, behavioral finance, product design ethics), we say so plainly rather than forcing a fit.

Frameworks cited:

- **Jump$tart** — Jump$tart Coalition National Standards in K-12 Personal Finance Education (benchmarks coded by Standard, Grade, Item — e.g., "Standard 1, Benchmark 4-2"). Standards: 1 Spending and Saving · 2 Credit and Debt · 3 Employment and Income · 4 Investing · 5 Risk Management and Insurance · 6 Financial Decision Making.
- **CEE** — Council for Economic Education National Standards for Financial Literacy. Standards: 1 Earning Income · 2 Buying Goods and Services · 3 Saving · 4 Using Credit · 5 Financial Investing · 6 Protecting and Insuring.
- **CCSS-Math** — Common Core State Standards in Mathematics.
- **CCSS-ELA** — Common Core State Standards in English Language Arts.
- **C3** — NCSS College, Career, and Civic Life Framework (Economics dimension D2.Eco.1–15).
- **CASEL** — Collaborative for Academic, Social, and Emotional Learning competencies.
- **NGSS-ETS** — Next Generation Science Standards Engineering Design (K-2-ETS1, 3-5-ETS1, MS-ETS1, HS-ETS1) — used wherever students design a product or process.

For each grade we list the 3–6 benchmarks the year actually centers, plus any honest gaps where the program teaches something not named in published frameworks.

Kindergarten — "Businesses help people"

- **Jump$tart Standard 3 (Employment and Income), Benchmark 4-1:** Identify various forms of income and reasons people work. (Cash teaches this at K via "people in our community do jobs that help us.")
- **Jump$tart Standard 1 (Spending and Saving), Benchmark 4-1:** Distinguish between needs and wants. (K-friendly: snacks vs. toys.)
- **CEE Standard 1 (Earning Income), Grade 4 Benchmark:** People have many different types of jobs from which to choose.
- **CCSS-Math K.MD.A.2 / K.CC.B.4:** Counting and comparing — applied to coin recognition and "which is more."
- **CCSS-ELA RL.K.3:** Identify characters, settings, and major events in a story — applied to picture books like A Chair for My Mother.
- **CASEL Self-Awareness:** Recognize one's own emotions about classroom roles (customer, worker).

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- **C3 D2.Eco.2.K-2:** Identify the goods and services that people in the community produce and those that are produced in other communities.
- **Honest gap:** Entrepreneurship-as-noticing-need is not named at K in Jump$tart/CEE; we teach it because it scaffolds what the program builds toward.

Grade 1 — "Businesses make things or do things"

- **Jump$tart Standard 3 (Employment and Income), Benchmark 4-2:** Describe how people use income for goods and services.
- **CEE Standard 1 (Earning Income), Grade 4:** Workers can improve their ability to earn income by gaining new knowledge, skills, and experiences.
- **CCSS-Math 1.MD.C.4 / 1.OA.A.1:** Adding and comparing — applied to coin counting up to 50¢.
- **CCSS-ELA SL.1.4:** Describe people, places, things, and events with relevant details, expressing ideas and feelings clearly — used in classroom store role-play.
- **C3 D2.Eco.1.K-2:** Explain how scarcity necessitates decision making — at the level of "we only have so many cookies."
- **CASEL Relationship Skills:** Cooperation in a worker/customer pair.
- **Honest gap:** "Make/do" framing is original to this curriculum; designed to bridge K's "businesses help" to 2's "businesses solve."

Grade 2 — "Businesses solve problems"

- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 4-1:** Identify the costs and benefits of a financial decision. (Made age-appropriate via "would the customer pay for this?")
- **CEE Standard 2 (Buying Goods and Services), Grade 4:** When buying a good or service, people consider what they want and what they can afford.
- **CCSS-Math 2.MD.C.8:** Solve word problems involving dollar bills, quarters, dimes, nickels, and pennies — center of "make change from $1."
- **CCSS-ELA W.2.2:** Write informative/explanatory texts — Problem→Idea cards practice this.
- **NGSS-ETS K-2-ETS1-1:** Ask questions, make observations, and gather information about a situation people want to change. (Direct fit for "businesses solve problems.")
- **CASEL Responsible Decision-Making:** Identify a problem and propose a solution.
- **C3 D2.Eco.5.K-2:** Identify prices of products, including taxes, that people pay for what they want.

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Grade 3 — "Business ideas come from skills, hobbies, and needs"

- **Jump$tart Standard 3 (Employment and Income), Benchmark 4-3:** Describe entrepreneurship and how people start small businesses.
- **CEE Standard 1 (Earning Income), Grade 4:** People can earn income by working for others or themselves (entrepreneurship).
- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 4-2:** Use a basic decision-making process to make a choice.
- **CCSS-Math 3.OA.D.8:** Solve two-step word problems using the four operations — used for cost/revenue/profit.
- **CCSS-ELA W.3.1:** Write opinion pieces — students defend their picked idea.
- **C3 D2.Eco.10.3-5:** Explain why individuals, businesses, and governments specialize.
- **NGSS-ETS 3-5-ETS1-1:** Define a simple design problem reflecting a need or a want.
- **CASEL Self-Awareness:** Identify one's own skills and interests.

Grade 4 — "Businesses need a simple plan"

- **Jump$tart Standard 1 (Spending and Saving), Benchmark 4-3:** Outline a plan for buying a needed or wanted item — extended at G4 to a small business plan.
- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 4-3:** Apply the steps of a decision-making process.
- **CEE Standard 2 (Buying Goods and Services), Grade 4:** Planning for spending can help people make informed choices.
- **CCSS-Math 4.OA.A.3:** Solve multistep word problems with whole numbers — used in the 5-question Reality Check.
- **CCSS-Math 4.MD.A.2:** Use the four operations to solve word problems involving distances, intervals of time, money — used in event budgeting under a cap.
- **CCSS-ELA W.4.4:** Produce clear and coherent writing — 1-sentence customer statement, 1-page plan.
- **NGSS-ETS 3-5-ETS1-2:** Generate and compare multiple possible solutions to a problem.
- **C3 D2.Eco.4.3-5:** Explain why incentives vary between buyers and sellers.

Grade 5 — "Money, pricing, and profit"

- **Jump$tart Standard 1 (Spending and Saving), Benchmark 4-4:** Develop a basic spending plan with set income and prioritized expenses.
- **CEE Standard 2 (Buying Goods and Services), Grade 8:** Comparison shopping — kid version (price + quality).

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- **Jump$tart Standard 3 (Employment and Income), Benchmark 4-4:** Identify factors that influence the level of income earned. (Adapted to "what makes prices what they are.")
- **CCSS-Math 5.NBT.B.7:** Add, subtract, multiply, and divide decimals — used in unit cost and pricing.
- **CCSS-Math 5.NF.B.6:** Solve real-world problems involving multiplication of fractions and mixed numbers — used in target-margin pricing.
- **CCSS-ELA SL.5.4:** Report on a topic in an organized manner — 30-second elevator pitch.
- **C3 D2.Eco.7.3-5:** Explain how profits influence sellers in markets.
- **CASEL Responsible Decision-Making:** Evaluating consequences of pricing choices.
- **Honest gap:** "Targeted persuasion in ads" is taught here as media-literacy-meets-business; it sits across CCSS-ELA and emerging financial-literacy standards but is not specifically named in Jump$tart at G5.

Grade 6 — "Businesses need systems and roles"

- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 8-1:** Apply systematic decision making to a medium-term financial goal.
- **CEE Standard 1 (Earning Income), Grade 8:** People who own and run their own business take risks but also have the potential for higher rewards. (Connects to roles and accountability.)
- **CCSS-Math 6.RP.A.3:** Use ratio and rate reasoning to solve real-world problems — used in savings-rate goal as a percentage.
- **CCSS-Math 6.SP.B.5:** Summarize numerical data sets in relation to their context — light use in monthly ledger.
- **CCSS-ELA W.6.2:** Write informative/explanatory texts — SOP writing.
- **C3 D2.Eco.6.6-8:** Explain how changes in supply and demand cause changes in prices.
- **CASEL Relationship Skills:** Negotiation, role clarity (RACI).
- **Honest gap:** RACI and SOPs are operational concepts not specifically named in K-12 standards; we teach them because they're how real teams work.

Grade 7 — "Know your customer"

- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 8-3:** Apply systematic decision making to identify the role of emotion in making financial decisions. (Customer empathy is the analog here.)
- **CEE Standard 2 (Buying Goods and Services), Grade 8:** People can use information from sellers and outside reviewers to compare products. (We flip it: students learn to be the seller making honest claims.)

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- **CCSS-Math 7.RP.A.3:** Use proportional relationships to solve multistep ratio and percent problems — used in per-customer revenue and contribution margin.
- **CCSS-Math 7.SP.A.1 / 7.SP.A.2:** Use random sampling to draw inferences — applied to small-sample customer surveys.
- **CCSS-ELA W.7.7:** Conduct short research projects — customer interview write-ups.
- **CCSS-ELA SL.7.1:** Engage effectively in collaborative discussions — interview practice + team huddles.
- **C3 D2.Eco.4.6-8:** Explain how changes in supply and demand cause changes in prices and quantities.
- **CASEL Social Awareness:** Perspective-taking — central to building a customer persona.
- **NGSS-ETS MS-ETS1-1:** Define the criteria and constraints of a design problem with sufficient precision — applied to customer problem statements.
- **Honest gap:** "Customer persona" is a marketing-discipline construct not in Jump$tart/CEE but central to entrepreneurship; we teach it explicitly.

Grade 8 — "Measure, improve, and operate smarter"

- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 8-2:** Identify ways that consumers may avoid making poor decisions — extended to running iterative tests.
- **CEE Standard 5 (Financial Investing), Grade 8:** Investors who own a corporation's stock or a corporate bond can earn a return — applied conceptually to "owners take risks for returns."
- **CCSS-Math 8.EE.C.7 / 8.F.B.4:** Linear equations and functions — break-even is a piecewise linear function.
- **CCSS-Math 8.SP.A.1:** Patterns of association in bivariate data — used in mini A/B test analysis.
- **CCSS-ELA W.8.1:** Write arguments — variance explanation.
- **C3 D2.Eco.5.6-8:** Explain ways in which money facilitates exchange.
- **NGSS-ETS MS-ETS1-3:** Analyze data from tests to determine similarities and differences among several design solutions — direct fit for the A/B test.
- **CASEL Self-Management:** Goal-setting, self-monitoring (PDSA).
- **Honest gap:** PDSA is a quality-improvement discipline not named in standards; we teach it because it's how real businesses get better.

Grade 9 — "Entrepreneurship is organized problem-solving"

- **Jump$tart Standard 1 (Spending and Saving), Benchmark 12-1:** Develop a plan for spending and saving — extended to a venture P&L.

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- **Jump$tart Standard 3 (Employment and Income), Benchmark 12-3:** Explain how taxes, government transfer payments, and employee benefits relate to disposable income — touched at survey level.
- **CEE Standard 1 (Earning Income), Grade 12:** Entrepreneurs accept the risks in organizing resources to produce goods and services and hope to earn profits.
- **CCSS-Math A-CED.A.2:** Create equations in two or more variables — used in P&L modeling.
- **CCSS-Math S-IC.B.4:** Estimate from a sample — applied to 5-interview customer discovery.
- **CCSS-ELA W.9-10.7 / RST.9-10.7:** Conduct research and integrate technical information — central to discovery cycle.
- **CCSS-ELA SL.9-10.4:** Present findings clearly and concisely.
- **C3 D2.Eco.2.9-12:** Use marginal benefits and marginal costs to construct an argument — directly used in MVP go/no-go.
- **NGSS-ETS HS-ETS1-2:** Design a solution to a complex real-world problem by breaking it down into smaller, more manageable problems.
- **CASEL Responsible Decision-Making:** Analyze consequences of various actions for personal, social, and collective well-being.

Grade 10 — "Ownership structure, money, and compliance"

- **Jump$tart Standard 2 (Credit and Debt), Benchmark 12-3:** Compare sources of consumer credit — extended to small-business funding sources.
- **Jump$tart Standard 5 (Risk Management and Insurance), Benchmark 12-1:** Identify risks in life and how to manage them — applied to business-structure liability.
- **CEE Standard 4 (Using Credit), Grade 12:** Borrowing money usually involves repaying both the principal and the interest.
- **CCSS-Math A-SSE.B.3 / F-IF.C.8:** Choose and produce equivalent forms — used in funding-source comparison spreadsheets.
- **CCSS-ELA W.9-10.1:** Write arguments to support claims with valid reasoning — defending a vision statement.
- **C3 D2.Eco.10.9-12:** Use current data to explain the influence of changes in spending, production, and the money supply on various economic conditions.
- **CASEL Responsible Decision-Making:** Considering ethical responsibility.
- **Honest gap:** Premortem is a Klein-style decision-quality tool, not in any K-12 framework; we teach it because it works.

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Grade 11 — "Leadership, sales, and execution"

- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 12-4:** Apply systematic decision-making to long-term goals.
- **Jump$tart Standard 3 (Employment and Income), Benchmark 12-2:** Explore career paths of interest — including entrepreneurship as a path.
- **CEE Standard 1 (Earning Income), Grade 12:** Income from self-employment is not the same as profit — explicitly taught in cash-flow forecasting.
- **CCSS-Math A-REI.D.10 / F-LE.A.1:** Linear, exponential, quadratic models — applied in cash-flow forecasts and growth projections.
- **CCSS-ELA SL.11-12.4:** Present information, findings, and supporting evidence — investor-style pitch.
- **CCSS-ELA SL.11-12.3:** Evaluate a speaker's point of view, reasoning, and use of evidence — applied to peer pitch critique.
- **C3 D2.Eco.13.9-12:** Explain why advancements in technology and investments in capital goods and human capital increase economic growth.
- **CASEL Relationship Skills:** Conflict management, leadership.
- **NGSS-ETS HS-ETS1-3:** Evaluate a solution to a complex real-world problem based on prioritized criteria and trade-offs.

Grade 12 — "Launch-ready entrepreneurship"

- **Jump$tart Standard 1 (Spending and Saving), Benchmark 12-2:** Develop a system for keeping and using financial records — applied to startup financial pack.
- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 12-1:** Apply reliable information and systematic decision making — capstone Launch-or-Learn decision.
- **Jump$tart Standard 5 (Risk Management and Insurance), Benchmark 12-3:** Evaluate the cost and benefit of various types of insurance — touched at small-business insurance.
- **CEE Standard 6 (Protecting and Insuring), Grade 12:** People can choose to accept risk or to take steps to protect themselves.
- **CCSS-Math S-MD.B.5 / S-MD.B.7:** Use probability to evaluate outcomes of decisions — used in scenario planning.
- **CCSS-ELA W.11-12.1 / SL.11-12.4:** Argument writing + presenting findings — Capstone defense.
- **C3 D2.Eco.7.9-12:** Use benefits and costs to evaluate the effectiveness of government policies — touched in compliance unit.
- **CASEL Self-Awareness + Responsible Decision-Making:** Recognizing strengths, identifying solutions for personal and community challenges — both load in Capstone.
- **NGSS-ETS HS-ETS1-1:** Analyze a major global challenge to specify qualitative and quantitative criteria — for ventures with social/environmental angle.

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Notes on alignment philosophy

- **Three to six benchmarks per grade is the target.** When an alignment is genuine, it earns its place. When it's a stretch, we admit the gap rather than write "addresses CCSS broadly."
- **State frameworks override.** Schools in Florida, Virginia, Texas, etc. should treat their state's K-12 personal-finance framework as primary and use Jump$tart/CEE as supplements.
- **Honest gaps make the program credible, not weaker.** A school administrator who reads "this is how this curriculum departs from named standards, and why" trusts the document more than one that pretends all benchmarks fit.

One promise.

Standards-rigorous. District-defensible. Foundation-fundable.

Cash to Company is built so a curriculum coordinator, a foundation officer, a parent, or a teacher can pick up any one of these strategic references and meet the program at full strength on the first page.

No promise of wealth. No probing of family finances. No partisan content. One question, asked patiently for thirteen years: which people, and how do you know?

For educational and operational use. This document is informational and does not constitute financial, legal, or tax advice. Standards alignment is cited per the Cash to Company Standards Alignment Map (Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, CASEL, NGSS-ETS).